Okoth Michael Chariga

Research, Evaluation & Data Systems Specialist

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PROFILE

Research and impact professional with five years of experience in monitoring, evaluation and learning (MEL) systems, participatory agricultural research and data-driven programme design across Kenya and Tanzania. Coordinates partner organisations, builds data systems that field teams can run, deploys R Shiny dashboards for farmer tracking and co-implements randomised controlled trials with research partners. Co-author of maths education papers and presenter at AFRICME7.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Monitoring, evaluation and learning (MEL) system design
- Baseline, midline and endline studies
- Randomised controlled trial field support
- Participatory and farmer-led research
- Survey design, sampling and field protocols
- Enumerator training and data quality assurance
- Data cleaning, analysis and reporting
- Dashboards: R Shiny, Streamlit, Power BI, Excel
- Partner coordination and capacity building
- Maths education, curriculum and facilitation

EXPERIENCE

Research & Impact Lead

Present

INNODEMS, Kakamega, Kenya

- Lead MEL and research support across agroecology, education and parenting programmes in Kenya and Tanzania, coordinating multiple partner organisations
- Support the Kenya Agroecology Hub and CRFS grantees in western Kenya, directly supporting 10 partner organisations working in agroecology
- Designed and ran a six month pilot in Kuria West testing whether pupils can support farmers in data recording while improving their learning
- Supported Farmer Research Networks on termite management, socio-cultural barriers to agroecology uptake, fermented feeds, and farmer training and follow-up, funded by CRFS (McKnight), the Agroecology Fund and the Conservation Food and Health Foundation
- Co-authored the Field Assessment Report for the Kenya Agroecology Hub (funded by the Conservation Food and Health Foundation): an endline evaluation of farmer training across 10 partner organisations, 42 sub-counties and 223 farmers, assessing 63 agroecology practices
- Design data collection tools in KoboCollect, train data collectors, prepare field protocols, clean and analyse data, and build dashboards in Python, Excel and R Shiny
- Deployed R Shiny dashboards used to track more than 1,000 farmers and managed the evaluation budget alongside the finance lead
- Supported the ParentApp for Teens randomised controlled trial in Mwanza, Tanzania for the Global Parenting Initiative: collected caregiver consent, followed up participants and resolved app problems on their phones

Volunteer Facilitator and Evaluation Support

Ongoing

Africa Maths Initiative (AMI), Kenya and Tanzania

- Created and facilitated hands-on, gamified maths lessons at camps including the STEM BootCamp with Project Inspire (Arusha), Kongoni (twice), Nyahera Girls, Nyarongi (twice), Rombo Girls and Good Shepherd Minor Seminary
- Designed baseline and endline data collection tools, analysed camp data and contributed to camp reports, covering 13 camps and over 3,000 participants
- Co-authored two maths camp papers and presented the AMI camps at the AFRICME7 conference in Johannesburg
- Supported international volunteers with travel logistics and local planning

EDUCATION

BSc Mathematics with IT, Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology 2022

Postgraduate Diploma in Leadership and Accountability, Open University of Kenya In progress

Aspire Leaders Program, Aspire Institute 2025

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

- **Facilitating a Positive Shift in Students' Engagement with Mathematics: Insights from 21 Maths Camps**. AFRICME7 Book of Conference Proceedings, 2025
- **From Players to Pedagogues: The AMI Maths Camp Model as a Catalyst for Teacher Professional Learning**. Mathematics Teacher Education and Development, Awaiting publication
- **Digital Math Activities and Parent-Child Playful Learning with the Early Family Math (EFM) App**. Co-authored paper

REPORTS

- **Field Assessment Report: Improving Farmer Training on AE Practices Through Collaboration and Follow-up**. Kenya Agroecology Hub, Manor House Agricultural Centre, with Muchugia Susan, 2026
- **Promoting Student Learning in Support of a Farmer Research Network in Migori County: Report on a Pilot Study**. Co-author, with Tekviah Munandi, Esther Njeri and Evans Odhiambo
- **Exploring Farmer Practices and Perspectives on Using Tephrosia for Internal and External Livestock Parasite Treatments: Findings from Focus Group Discussions**. Author, Rural Farmers Research Network, January 2025
- **Fermented Feeds Research: Lab Results and Nutrient Analysis Report**. Kenya Agroecology Hub Community of Practice presentation, 2026

AWARDS

- KENET conference funding to present at AFRICME7, Wits School of Education, Johannesburg (2025)
- Aspire Leaders Program alumnus (2025)

TOOLS

R and R Shiny · Python and Streamlit · SQL · KoboToolbox and KoboCollect · ODK · SurveyCTO · CommCare · Power BI · Excel · Notion · GitHub

Referees available on request.